THE ROLE OF A PRODUCT MANAGER

Without sales nobody would sell.

Without engineering nobody would build.

Without support, customers would riot.

Without product managers?

Life would be just fine.

(For a while.)

Ken Norton (Leading Cross - Functional Teams)
https://speakerdeck.com/kennethn/leading-cross-functional-teams-and-the-product-manager

WHAT DOES A PRODUCT MANAGER DO ?

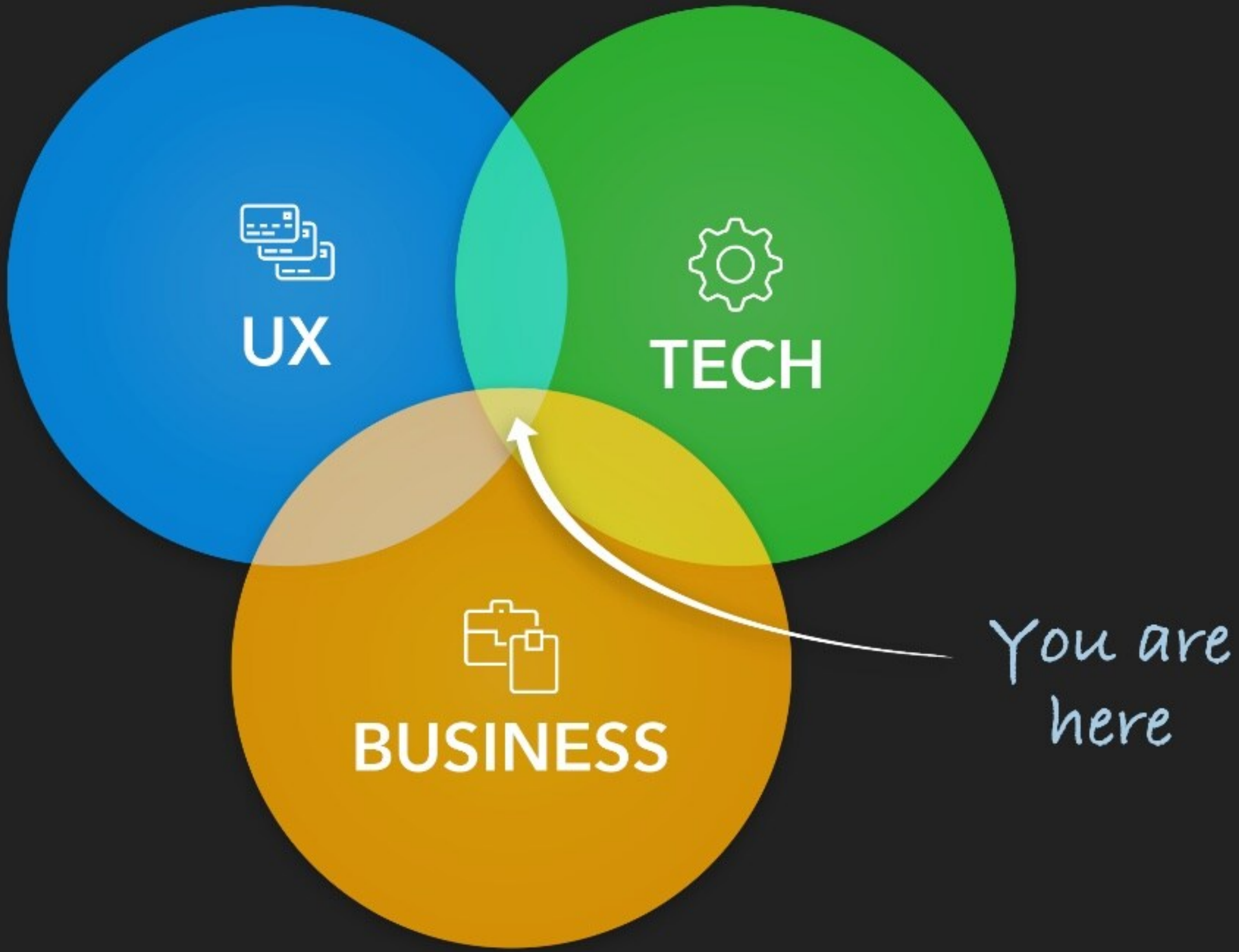
The product manager is often considered
“the CEO of their product”.

Responsible for

- Strategy
- Roadmap
- Feature definition

Might do*

- Marketing
- Forecasting
- Profit and loss (P&L)


UX
TECH
BUSINESS
You are here

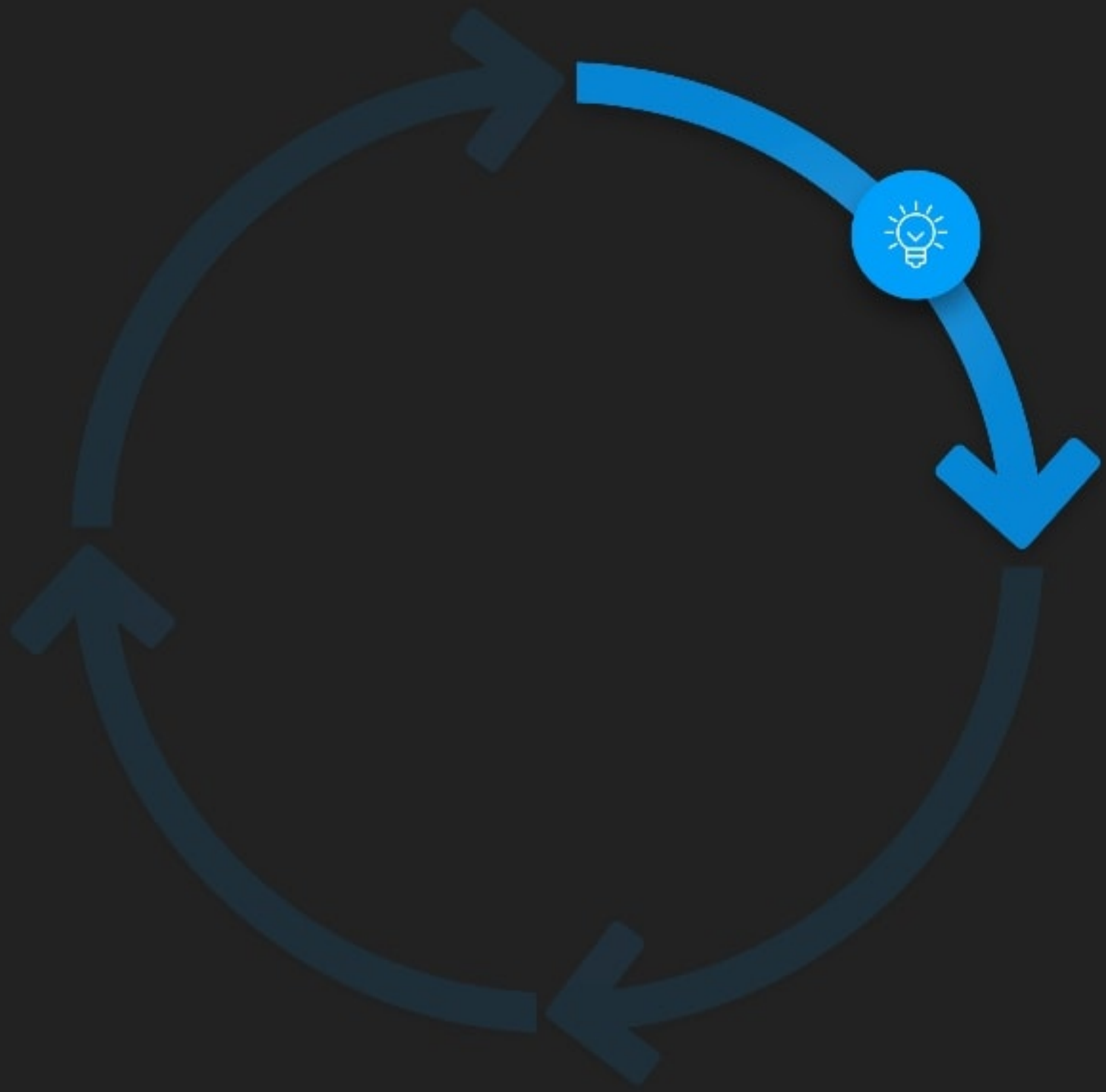
WHAT A PRODUCT MANAGER DOESN'T DO

- Write code or take charge of technical decisions
- Own the project management tasks & resources
- Create design mockups
- Sign deals
- Plan PR

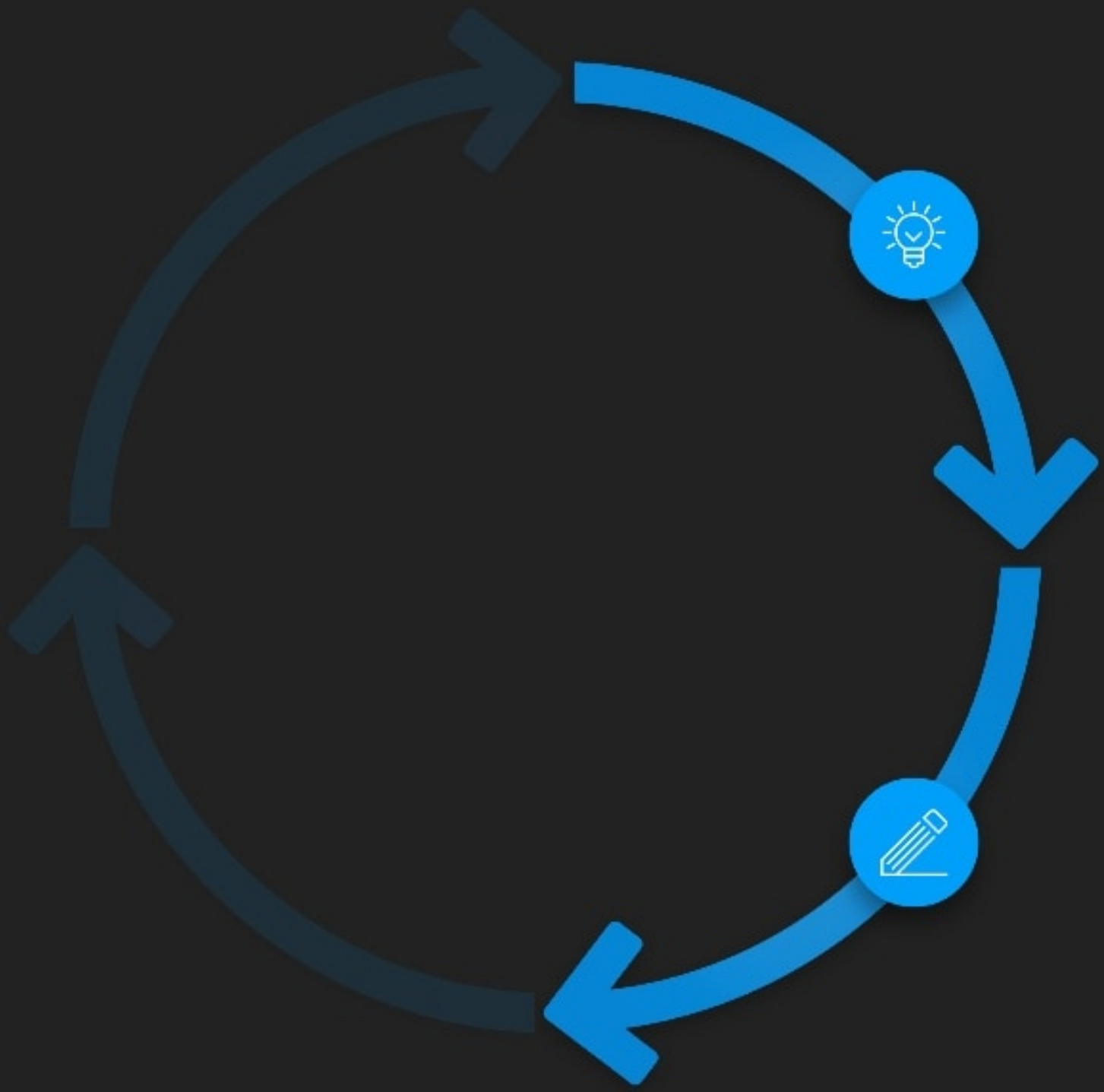


PRODUCT LIFECYCLE

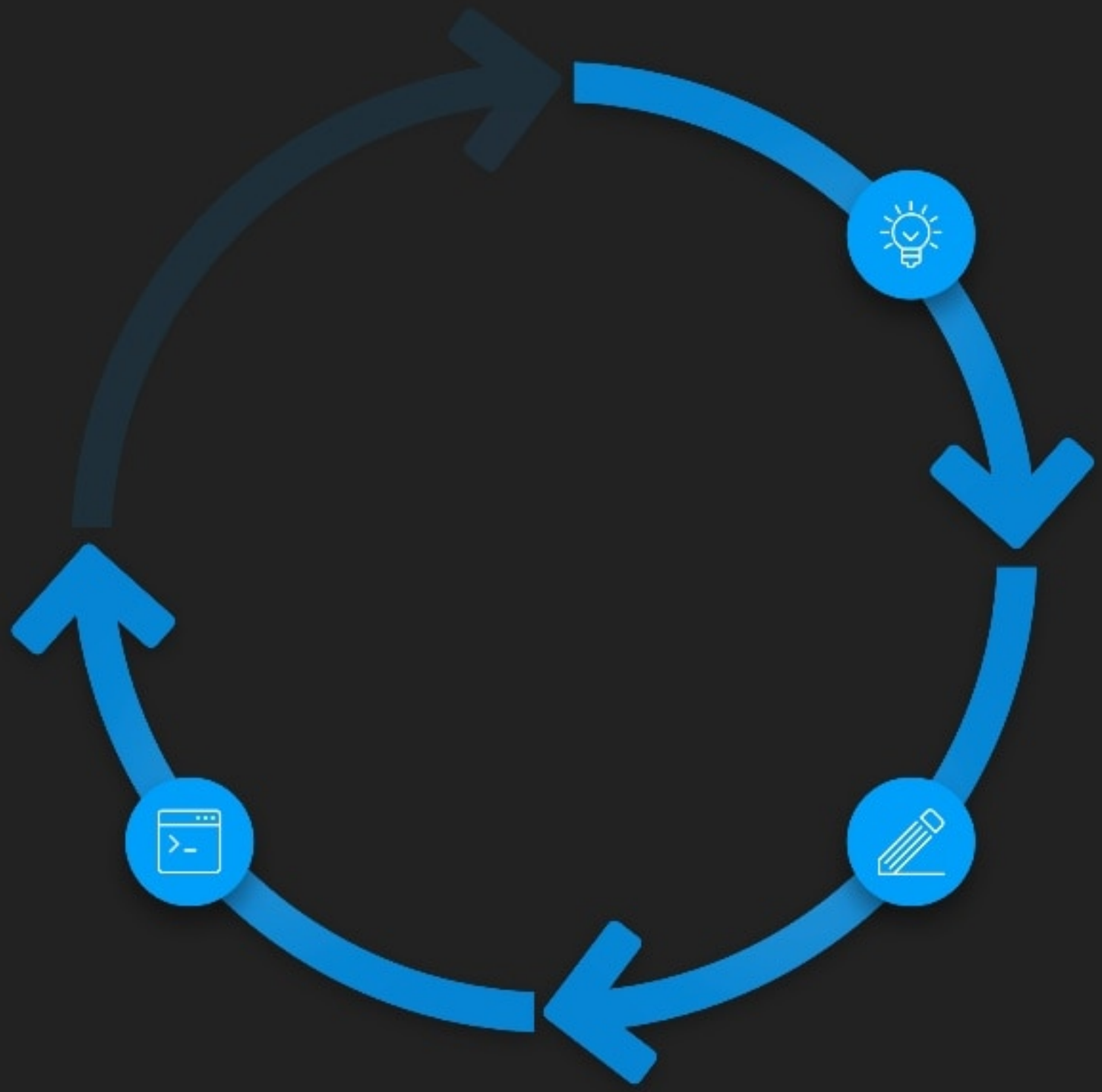
PRODUCT MANAGER'S RESPONSIBILITIES



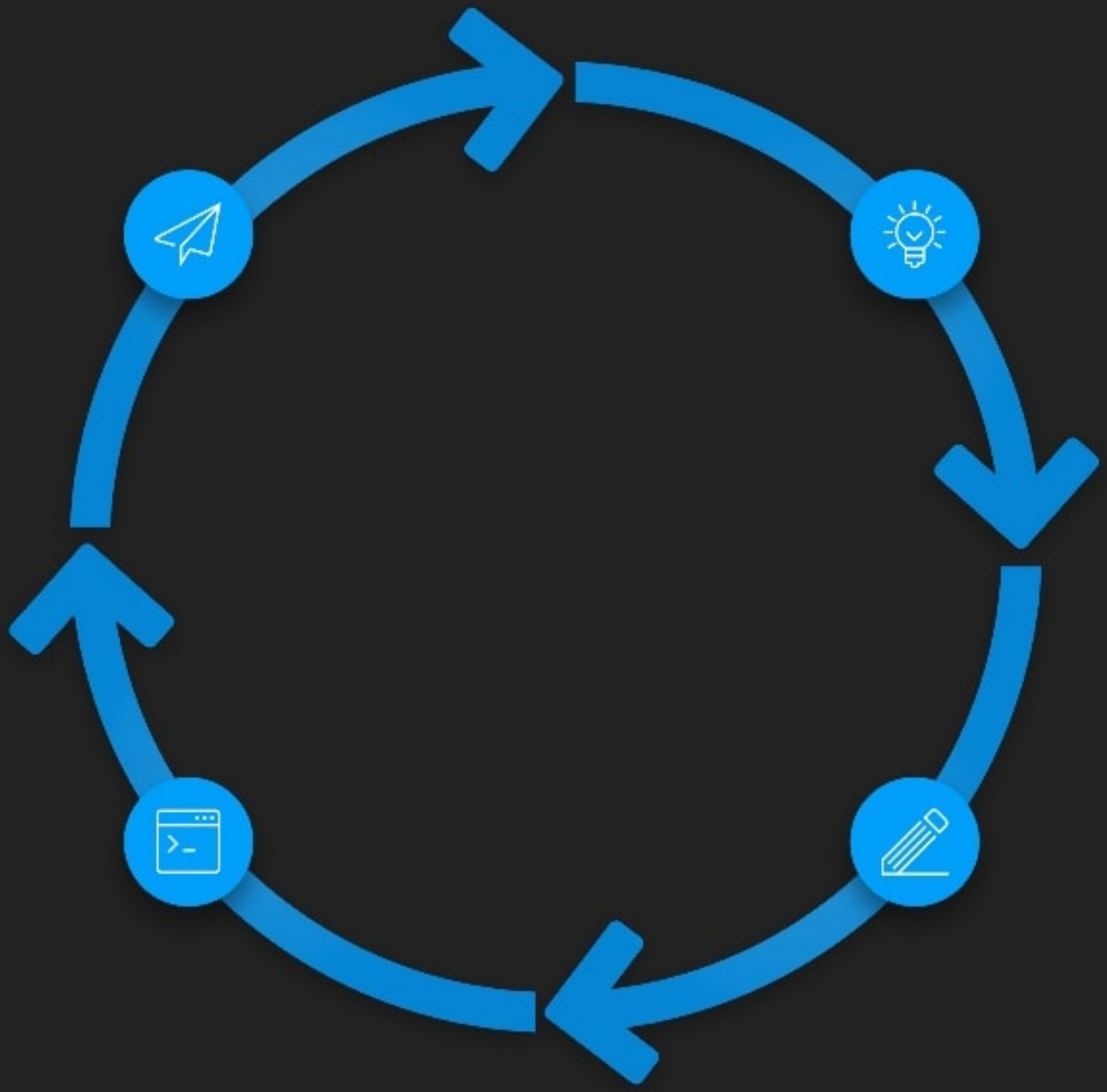
1. Define



1. Define
2. Design



1. Define
2. Design
3. Build



1. Define
2. Design
3. Build
4. Ship



1. Define
2. Design
3. Build
4. Ship

DEFINE THE PRODUCT

YOU ARE

THE RESEARCHER

DEFINE THE PRODUCT

- Conduct market & competitive analysis
- Conduct customer research
- Capture and brainstorm product ideas
- Define initial product vision and strategy
- Build the product business case

DESIGN THE PRODUCT

YOU ARE

THE ARCHITECT

DESIGN THE PRODUCT

- Define product requirements
- Sketch product functionalities
- Persona development
- Contribute to initial prototype
- UX testing and research

BUILD THE PRODUCT

YOU ARE

THE CUSTOMER ADVOCATE

BUILD THE PRODUCT

- Engage in the development process
- Manage and prioritise the product backlog
- Anticipate product flaws and propose solutions
- Document, analyse and communicate decisions
- Define with marketing the product identity and branding
- Plan the release

SHIP THE PRODUCT

YOU ARE

THE EVANGELIST

SHIP THE PRODUCT

- Define customer communication and positioning with the marketing team
- Define acceptance criteria for the launch
- Prepare documents (and training sessions) for sales and customer support teams
- Go to person for press and analyst relations

DAY TO DAY

YOU ARE

THE PRODUCT MANAGER

DAY TO DAY

- Reporting and product analysis
- Analyse customer behaviour
- Support marketing and sales
- Customer's voice in the agile process
- Update and communicate the product roadmap

KILL THE PRODUCT*

WHO CAN BE A PRODUCT MANAGER?





DIFFERENT PM FLAVOURS



Strategic
Product Manager



Tehnical
Product Manager



Product
Marketing Manager

KEY TAKEAWAYS

1. Know your customer and market
2. Identify problems to be solved
3. Lead by influence
4. Involve people early in the process
5. Document and communicate decisions
6. Measure your product's success
7. Find your PM flavour